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Method and apparatus for delivering a thermal shock

Abstract

The subject disclosure relates to a system and method for testing units-under-test (UUT) with a thermal shock. The thermal shock testing system can include a chamber having an inlet and an outlet, the chamber being configured to provide a thermal shock to a unit-under-test (UUT), a pump configured to fluidly connect to the inlet of the chamber and direct a temperature controlled liquid through a channel embedded in the chamber, and a boiler and a chiller fluidly connected to the pump, the temperature of the liquid being controlled by at least one valve configured to alternatively direct hot or cold fluid to the inlet of the chamber.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation and claims the benefit of U.S. application Ser. No. 16/832,213, filed on Mar. 27, 2020, entitled “METHOD AND APPARATUS FOR DELIVERING A THERMAL SHOCK,” which claims priority to U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/967,791, filed on Jan. 30, 2020, entitled “METHOD AND APPARATUS FOR DELIVERING A THERMAL SHOCK,” the contents of which are expressly incorporated by reference herein in their entirety for all purposes.

BACKGROUND

1. Technical Field

(1) The subject technology provides solutions for testing units-under-test and in particular, for providing a thermal shock test to the units-under-test.

2. Introduction

(2) Standard high and low temperature environmental thermal shock tests are configured to test the capability of material structure or composite materials to determine how the material withstands continuous environmental changes between extreme high temperatures and low temperatures. The thermal shock tests provide information regarding physical damages, chemical changes, and

operational problems that are caused due to thermal expansion (i.e., from the heat) and contraction (i.e., from the cold) in a short period of time relative to expected operational timeframes. The thermal expansion and contraction caused by the temperature change generates stress because of the different expansion rates of the materials within the device being tested.

(3) Repeated stress causes accumulated fatigue, leading to various failure modes such as cracks and rupturing at a lower strength than the static strength. Repeated stress tests can also cause coatings to peel and screws to loosen. The thermal shock test is used in the automotive industry to simulate adaptability of units-under-test (UUT) in rapid changes of surrounding atmospheric temperature or to provide reliability test and product screening for UUT qualification and validation. The quality of the products being tested also can be controlled through this process for product improvement.

(4) There are currently two types of thermal shock tests, air-to-air and liquid-to-liquid. The air-to-air thermal shock method is more popularly used by placing UUTs in a test chamber, which is divided into a two-chamber type dynamic shock and a three-chamber type static shock, according to the specificity of the UUT being tested. The liquid-to-liquid thermal shock method applies thermal shocks to the UUTs by alternately immersing the UUTs into partitioned high and low temperature liquid mediums in separate tanks. In the liquid-to-liquid thermal shock method, very high thermal ramp rates can be achieved when compared to the air-to-air thermal shock method. As such, the liquid-to-liquid thermal shock test is considered to be a more stringent thermal shock method than the air-to-air method in terms of acceleration.

(5) Conventional methods for liquid-to-liquid thermal shock are cumbersome and inefficient. Immersion of UUTs within high and low temperature mediums requires a hoist assembly to lift UUTs and transfer the UUT between high and low temperature tanks. Transferring UUTs between tanks is labor and time intensive, especially for large UUTs. To avoid damage to sensitive electrical equipment, an entirety of an outer surface of the UUT may require water proofing. Due to the nature of thermal shock testing, water proofing material can become damaged resulting in thermal shock testing disruption or failure.

(6) As such, a need exists for an apparatus and a method that can perform a thermal shock test more efficiently and effectively while including the benefits of a liquid-to-liquid thermal shock test.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Certain features of the subject technology are set forth in the appended claims. However, the accompanying drawings, which are included to provide further understanding, illustrate disclosed aspects and together with the description serve to explain the principles of the subject technology. In the drawings:

(2) FIG. 1 illustrates an example environment that includes an autonomous vehicle in communication with a remote computing system, according to some aspects of the disclosed technology.

(3) FIG. 2 illustrates a perspective view of an autonomous vehicle, according to some aspects of the disclosed technology.

(4) FIG. 3A illustrates an example schematic diagrams of a thermal shock testing system, according to some aspects of the disclosed technology.

(5) FIG. 3B illustrates an example schematic diagrams of a thermal shock testing system, according to some aspects of the disclosed technology.

(6) FIG. 4 illustrates an example schematic diagrams of a thermal shock testing system, according to some aspects of the disclosed technology.

(7) FIG. 5 illustrates a perspective view of an example thermal shock testing system, according to some aspects of the disclosed technology.

- (8) FIG. 6 illustrates a cross-sectional side view of a chamber of an example thermal shock testing system, according to some aspects of the disclosed technology.
- (9) FIG. 7 illustrates an example schematic diagram of a thermal shock testing system, according to some aspects of the disclosed technology.
- (10) FIG. 8 illustrates an example table of components of a thermal shock testing system, according to some aspects of the disclosed technology.
- (11) FIG. 9 illustrates an example table of parameters of a thermal shock testing system, according to some aspects of the disclosed technology.
- (12) FIG. 10 illustrates an example thermal shock temperature profile of a thermal shock testing system, according to some aspects of the disclosed technology.
- (13) FIG. 11 illustrates an example process for providing a thermal shock to a unit-under-test, according to some aspects of the disclosed technology.
- (14) FIG. 12 illustrates an example processor-based system with which some aspects of the subject technology can be implemented.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(15) Various examples of the present technology are discussed in detail below. While specific implementations are discussed, it should be understood that this is done for illustration purposes only. A person skilled in the relevant art will recognize that other components and configurations may be used without parting from the spirit and scope of the present technology. In some instances, well-known structures and devices are shown in block diagram form in order to facilitate describing one or more aspects. Further, it is to be understood that functionality that is described as being carried out by certain system components may be performed by more or fewer components than shown.

(16) Faster processing speeds, increased capacity and functionality, and higher power density in autonomous vehicles (AV) produce more heat than prior generations of automobiles. As such, higher operating temperatures can rapidly outstrip the capability of air-based cooling systems. Higher operating temperatures increases the risk of reliability failures.

(17) Liquids have a high capacity for heat transfer and can remove and dissipate heat more quickly and effectively. However, such complicated and delicate computer systems cannot simply be immersed in a liquid medium. The liquid medium would short circuit boards and irreparably damage the electronic computer systems. For example, a liquid-to-liquid thermal shock test cannot be conducted on an AV compute electrical control unit (ECU) due to its weight load and incompatibility with liquids.

(18) The disclosed technologies address a need in the art for improvements in testing units-under-test. In some examples, a thermal shock testing system can include a chamber having a plurality of walls that is configured to provide the thermal shock to the UUT. The system further can include at least one channel being embedded within at least one wall of the plurality of walls of the chamber, wherein the at least one channel includes an inlet and an outlet. The system also can include a pump being connected to the chamber and configured to provide a liquid to the inlet of the at least one channel embedded in the chamber. The system can additionally include a boiler connected to the pump and configured to provide the liquid at a high temperature. The system further can include a chiller connected to the pump and configured to provide the liquid at a low temperature. The system also can include a plurality of valves connected to the boiler and the chiller, wherein the plurality of valves is configured to control the temperature of the liquid that is pumped to the chamber.

(19) FIG. 1 illustrates an example autonomous vehicle environment **100**. The example autonomous vehicle environment **100** includes an autonomous vehicle **102**, a remote computing system **150**, and a ridesharing application **170**. The autonomous vehicle **102**, remote computing system **150**, and ridesharing application **170** can communicate with each other over one or more networks, such as a public network (e.g., a public cloud, the Internet, etc.), a private network (e.g., a local area network,

a private cloud, a virtual private network, etc.), and/or a hybrid network (e.g., a multi-cloud or hybrid cloud network, etc.).

(20) The autonomous vehicle **102** can navigate about roadways without a human driver based on sensor signals generated by sensors **104-108** on the autonomous vehicle **102**. The sensors **104-108** on the autonomous vehicle **102** can include one or more types of sensors and can be arranged about the autonomous vehicle **102**. For example, the sensors **104-108** can include, without limitation, one or more inertial measuring units (IMUs), one or more image sensors (e.g., visible light image sensors, infrared image sensors, video camera sensors, surround view camera sensors, etc.), one or more light emitting sensors, one or more global positioning system (GPS) devices, one or more radars, one or more light detection and ranging sensors (LIDARs), one or more sonars, one or more accelerometers, one or more gyroscopes, one or more magnetometers, one or more altimeters, one or more tilt sensors, one or more motion detection sensors, one or more light sensors, one or more audio sensors, etc. In some implementations, sensor **104** can be a radar, sensor **106** can be a first image sensor (e.g., a visible light camera), and sensor **108** can be a second image sensor (e.g., a thermal camera). Other implementations can include any other number and type of sensors.

(21) The autonomous vehicle **102** can include several mechanical systems that are used to effectuate motion of the autonomous vehicle **102**. For instance, the mechanical systems can include, but are not limited to, a vehicle propulsion system **130**, a braking system **132**, and a steering system **134**. The vehicle propulsion system **130** can include an electric motor, an internal combustion engine, or both. The braking system **132** can include an engine brake, brake pads, actuators, and/or any other suitable componentry configured to assist in decelerating the autonomous vehicle **102**. The steering system **134** includes suitable componentry configured to control the direction of movement of the autonomous vehicle **102** during navigation.

(22) The autonomous vehicle **102** can include a safety system **136**. The safety system **136** can include lights and signal indicators, a parking brake, airbags, etc. The autonomous vehicle **102** can also include a cabin system **138**, which can include cabin temperature control systems, in-cabin entertainment systems, etc.

(23) The autonomous vehicle **102** can include an internal computing system **110** in communication with the sensors **104-108** and the systems **130**, **132**, **134**, **136**, and **138**. The internal computing system **110** includes one or more processors and at least one memory for storing instructions executable by the one or more processors. The computer-executable instructions can make up one or more services for controlling the autonomous vehicle **102**, communicating with remote computing system **150**, receiving inputs from passengers or human co-pilots, logging metrics regarding data collected by sensors **104-108** and human co-pilots, etc.

(24) The internal computing system **110** can include a control service **112** configured to control operation of the vehicle propulsion system **130**, the braking system **132**, the steering system **134**, the safety system **136**, and the cabin system **138**. The control service **112** can receive sensor signals from the sensors **104-108** can communicate with other services of the internal computing system **110** to effectuate operation of the autonomous vehicle **102**. In some examples, control service **112** may carry out operations in concert with one or more other systems of autonomous vehicle **102**.

(25) The internal computing system **110** can also include a constraint service **114** to facilitate safe propulsion of the autonomous vehicle **102**. The constraint service **116** includes instructions for activating a constraint based on a rule-based restriction upon operation of the autonomous vehicle **102**. For example, the constraint may be a restriction on navigation that is activated in accordance with protocols configured to avoid occupying the same space as other objects, abide by traffic laws, circumvent avoidance areas, etc. In some examples, the constraint service **114** can be part of the control service **112**.

(26) The internal computing system **110** can also include a communication service **116**. The communication service **116** can include software and/or hardware elements for transmitting and receiving signals to and from the remote computing system **150**. The communication service **116**

can be configured to transmit information wirelessly over a network, for example, through an antenna array or interface that provides cellular (long-term evolution (LTE), 3rd Generation (3G), 5th Generation (5G), etc.) communication.

(27) In some examples, one or more services of the internal computing system **110** are configured to send and receive communications to remote computing system **150** for reporting data for training and evaluating machine learning algorithms, requesting assistance from remote computing system **150** or a human operator via remote computing system **150**, software service updates, ridesharing pickup and drop off instructions, etc.

(28) The internal computing system **110** can also include a latency service **118**. The latency service **118** can utilize timestamps on communications to and from the remote computing system **150** to determine if a communication has been received from the remote computing system **150** in time to be useful. For example, when a service of the internal computing system **110** requests feedback from remote computing system **150** on a time-sensitive process, the latency service **118** can determine if a response was timely received from remote computing system **150**, as information can quickly become too stale to be actionable. When the latency service **118** determines that a response has not been received within a threshold period of time, the latency service **118** can enable other systems of autonomous vehicle **102** or a passenger to make decisions or provide needed feedback.

(29) The internal computing system **110** can also include a user interface service **120** that can communicate with cabin system **138** to provide information or receive information to a human co-pilot or passenger. In some examples, a human co-pilot or passenger can be asked or requested to evaluate and override a constraint from constraint service **114**. In other examples, the human co-pilot or passenger may wish to provide an instruction to the autonomous vehicle **102** regarding destinations, requested routes, or other requested operations.

(30) As described above, the remote computing system **150** can be configured to send and receive signals to and from the autonomous vehicle **102**. The signals can include, for example and without limitation, data reported for training and evaluating services such as machine learning services, data for requesting assistance from remote computing system **150** or a human operator, software service updates, rideshare pickup and drop off instructions, etc.

(31) The remote computing system **150** can include an analysis service **152** configured to receive data from autonomous vehicle **102** and analyze the data to train or evaluate machine learning algorithms for operating the autonomous vehicle **102**. The analysis service **152** can also perform analysis pertaining to data associated with one or more errors or constraints reported by autonomous vehicle **102**.

(32) The remote computing system **150** can also include a user interface service **154** configured to present metrics, video, images, sounds reported from the autonomous vehicle **102** to an operator of remote computing system **150**, maps, routes, navigation data, notifications, user data, vehicle data, software data, and/or any other content. User interface service **154** can receive, from an operator, input instructions for the autonomous vehicle **102**.

(33) The remote computing system **150** can also include an instruction service **156** for sending instructions regarding the operation of the autonomous vehicle **102**. For example, in response to an output of the analysis service **152** or user interface service **154**, instructions service **156** can prepare instructions to one or more services of the autonomous vehicle **102** or a co-pilot or passenger of the autonomous vehicle **102**.

(34) The remote computing system **150** can also include a rideshare service **158** configured to interact with ridesharing applications **170** operating on computing devices, such as tablet computers, laptop computers, smartphones, head-mounted displays (HMDs), gaming systems, servers, smart devices, smart wearables, and/or any other computing devices. In some cases, such computing devices can be passenger computing devices. The rideshare service **158** can receive from passenger ridesharing app **170** requests, such as user requests to be picked up or dropped off,

and can dispatch autonomous vehicle **102** for a requested trip.

(35) The rideshare service **158** can also act as an intermediary between the ridesharing app **170** and the autonomous vehicle **102**. For example, rideshare service **158** can receive from a passenger instructions for the autonomous vehicle **102**, such as instructions to go around an obstacle, change routes, honk the horn, etc. The rideshare service **158** can provide such instructions to the autonomous vehicle **102** as requested.

(36) The remote computing system **150** can also include a package service **162** configured to interact with the ridesharing application **170** and/or a delivery service **172** of the ridesharing application **170**. A user operating ridesharing application **170** can interact with the delivery service **172** to specify information regarding a package to be delivered using the autonomous vehicle **102**. The specified information can include, for example and without limitation, package dimensions, a package weight, a destination address, delivery instructions (e.g., a delivery time, a delivery note, a delivery constraint, etc.), and so forth.

(37) The package service **162** can interact with the delivery service **172** to provide a package identifier to the user for package labeling and tracking. Package delivery service **172** can also inform a user of where to bring their labeled package for drop off. In some examples, a user can request the autonomous vehicle **102** come to a specific location, such as the user's location, to pick up the package. While delivery service **172** has been shown as part of the ridesharing application **170**, it will be appreciated by those of ordinary skill in the art that delivery service **172** can be its own separate application.

(38) One beneficial aspect of utilizing autonomous vehicle **102** for both ridesharing and package delivery is increased utilization of the autonomous vehicle **102**. Instruction service **156** can continuously keep the autonomous vehicle **102** engaged in a productive itinerary between rideshare trips by filling what otherwise would have been idle time with productive package delivery trips.

(39) Embodiments include an apparatus and a method that perform a thermal shock test such that the unit-under-test (UUT) (e.g., a computer or an autonomous vehicle (AV) component) can function during and after abrupt and rapid fluctuations in temperature without experiencing degradation and loss in function.

(40) FIG. 2 illustrates a perspective view of an autonomous vehicle, according to some aspects of the disclosed technology. FIG. 2 further illustrates 3D axes including a Z-axis (up/down/vertical), an X-axis (fwd/aft/longitudinal), and a Y-axis (left/right/lateral).

(41) UUT Placement Orientation:

(42) UUT's in-test placement can mimic in-vehicle orientation, mounting condition, and frequency response characteristics. For example, in AV compute testing, UUTs can be placed approximately 19 degrees along the vertical Z-axis direction.

(43) Inspection and Measurement for Reliability Testing:

(44) UUTs can proceed through diagnostic checks including functional and cosmetic inspections before, during, and after testing to measure degradation in performance or catastrophic failures.

(45) Cosmetic inspection can include visually inspecting the UUT for variations in plastic and metal color, surface finish, gaps between adjacent features, signs of cracking, rupturing, screw loosening, deformation, warpage, corrosion, delamination, scratches, dents, bulges, bubbles, peeling, and any other variation suitable for the intended purpose and understood by a person of ordinary skill in the art.

(46) Functional Test can include a functional/parametric check to determine whether the UUT is functional. Functionality of input/output (I/O) connectors and mechanical moving parts can be checked.

(47) Dimensional checks can include performing a visual inspection and measuring gap/flush dimensions using a coordinate measuring machine (CMM) or a pair of calipers.

(48) Pass/Fail Criteria:

(49) The UUT can be considered as “passing” if it meets cosmetic, dimensional, and functionality

requirements during the test. For example, functional failures and mechanical damage are typically not allowed. In other embodiments, a certain level of cosmetic damage and/or dimensional change can be acceptable pending on an engineering risk assessment.

(50) Reliability Test Report:

(51) A reliability engineer also can provide a test report template that can be used as an overall summary of the test results. The reliability engineer executing the reliability test plan can generate data sheets to document objective and subjective data collected throughout the test. Updated reports can be sent to the reliability engineer every week or more frequently as test milestones are reached. All results can be reported as numerical values whenever possible. Test reports can include: 1) Results of pre-test, mid-test, and post-test cosmetic inspections, dimensional checks, and functional test logs. Pictures of cosmetic anomalies and dimensional changes also can be included. 2) Report pass/fail status of samples. 3) Photographs of the test setup including photos of the sample orientation in the chamber or dynamic fixture. 4) Photograph the sample before and after each test procedure. 5) Chamber logs (e.g., temperature and humidity as-run profiles).

(52) FIGS. 3A-6 illustrate example schematic diagrams and perspective views of an example thermal shock testing system **300**, according to some aspects of the disclosed technology.

(53) Reliability Test Procedure and Requirements:

(54) Embodiments of the thermal shock testing system **300** can include a chiller **302** (with cold coolant), a chiller/boiler **304** (with warm coolant), a chamber **306**, and a coldplate **308** or a thermally sealed box. In some instances, the thermal shock testing system **300** also can include circulating, alternately, cold coolant from the chiller **302** and warm coolant from the boiler **304** through the coldplate **308** to form a fast temperature change environment within the enclosure/chamber **306**. Such a temperature change environment induced by the cold and hot coolants can mimic a field condition more realistically. In addition to the temperature change, internal pressures of the liquid pipe and the heat pipe can be cyclically changed due to the fast temperature change.

(55) Example schematic and perspective setups of the liquid-to-liquid thermal shock testing system **300** are illustrated in FIGS. 3A-6 along with a hot/cold liquid input control algorithm. For example, a thermal cycling (dT) of -25 degrees Celsius to 85 degrees Celsius or larger dT can be used for testing solder joints, PCBs, and electrical connections. The minimum and maximum temperature values can be modified depending on the UUT and at the discretion of the reliability engineer.

(56) In some instances, the thermal shock testing system **300** can include a chamber **306** having an inlet **310**, an outlet **312**, and a coldplate **308**, a plurality of valves **314**, a pump **316**, a chiller (cold) **302**, and a chiller (hot) **304**. The chamber **306** can include a plurality of walls including a top wall **318**, a bottom wall **320**, and sidewalls **322**. In some instances, the bottom wall **320** can be the coldplate **308**.

(57) In other instances, the chamber **306** and/or the coldplate **308** of the thermal shock testing system **300** can include at least one channel **324** that facilitates the cold/hot liquid to flow from the inlet **310** to the outlet **312** of the thermal shock testing system **300**. The at least one channel **324** can be a channel, a cavity, a tube, a coil, a thermal coil or any other channel suitable for the intended purpose and understood by a person of ordinary skill in the art.

(58) The thermal shock testing system **300** can further include a plurality of channels **324** in the plurality of walls **318**, **320**, **322** of the chamber **306** and the coldplate **308** with corresponding inlets **310** and outlets **312** to provide various temperature regions throughout the walls **318**, **320**, **322** of the chamber **306** and the coldplate **308**, as shown in FIG. 5. In some cases, the channels **324** can form thermal coils **326** in various regions of the chamber **306** and the coldplate **308**. The thermal coils **326** can be planar (as illustrated in FIG. 5) or non-planar to the walls **318**, **320**, **322** of the chamber **306** and the coldplate **308**. For example, in FIG. 5, two thermal coils **326** are provided in one side wall **322**, while one thermal coil is provided in another side wall **322** and the bottom wall **320**/coldplate **308**. In other instances, different configurations including thermal coils **326** in the

top wall **318** of the chamber **306** and a varying number of thermal coils **326** in the plurality of walls **318**, **320**, **322** and the coldplate **308** are contemplated in this disclosure. Various quadrants of the walls **318**, **320**, **322** of the chamber **306** and/or the coldplate **308** can also have different temperatures based on the arrangement of the plurality of channels **324** in the system **300** so that a single UUT or multiple UUTs can experience different temperatures at the same time.

(59) The thermal shock testing system **300** also can be a “chamber in a chamber” thermal shock testing system **300**. For example, one chamber **306** can be positioned within another chamber **306** such that both chambers **306** are capable of providing a thermal shock test to a UUT. The coldplate **308** can serve as an independent thermal shock chamber to test the UUT, while also being inside the chamber **306** having an alternating cold and hot liquid circulation. Heat can be transferred by the liquid, instead of by the air, without having to move the UUT. The chamber **306** of the thermal shock testing system **300** can be an outer environmental chamber that includes an independent temperature control that can mimic a car being outside use-type environment.

(60) In further instances, the thermal shock testing system **300** can further include a flow meter (FM) **328** to determine the flow rate of the liquid in the thermal shock testing system **300**.

(61) In some instances, a temperature transducer (T) **330** and a pressure transducer (P) **332** can be positioned at an inlet of a source connector **334** and at an outlet of a return connector **336** of a device-under-test (DUT) of the thermal shock testing system **300**. The DUT may be similar to or the same as the UUT.

(62) In other instances, the plurality of valves **314** of the thermal shock testing system **300** can include a hot source valve **338**, a hot return valve **340**, a cold source valve **342**, and a cold return valve **344**. The thermal shock testing system **300** also can include a bypass valve **346** that can be positioned between the input of the temperature transducer **330** and pressure transducer **332** of the source connector **334** and the output of the temperature transducer **330** and pressure transducer **332** of the return connector **336**. The bypass valve **346** can maintain the temperature in piping when the DUT is not connected, which can allow continuous running of the chillers **302**, **304** to maximize up-time.

(63) In another instance, the thermal shock testing system **300** can include an in-line filter **348** at the DUT return along with a different pressure sensor (dP) **332** to evaluate when the system **300** is clogged.

(64) In some embodiments, fasteners can be used to secure the DUT to the chamber **306**/coldplate **308** of the thermal shock testing system **300**. For example, the fasteners can be used along a perimeter of the DUT to secure the DUT in a particular location of the chamber **306**/coldplate **308**. The fasteners can include magnets, latches, inserts, screws, tie downs, or any other fastener suitable for the intended purpose and understood by a person of ordinary skill in the art. Furthermore, the fasteners may be repositionable along the chamber **306**/coldplate **308** of the thermal shock testing system **300**. For example, if the DUT is to be positioned in a different position, the fasteners can be moved to secure the DUT in the new position. Moreover, if a new DUT is to be tested, the fasteners can be repositioned to the perimeter of the new DUT. In some instances, the DUT can be placed on top of the fasteners depending on the testing parameters.

(65) In other instances, the fasteners of the thermal shock testing system can be pedestals **350** as shown in FIG. **6**. The pedestals **350** can be configurable, thermally conductive pedestals that are positionable within the interior portion of the coldplate **308**/chamber **306** of the thermal shock testing system **300**. The pedestals **350** further can be independent of the coldplate **308**/chamber **306** of the thermal shock testing system **300**. The thermally conductive pedestals **350** can be made of metals with high thermal conductivity such as aluminum, copper, brass, steel, bronze, or any other metal with high thermal conductivity that is suitable for the intended purpose and understood by a person of ordinary skill in the art.

(66) In some instances, a DUT can include “hot” components that are operational and that are positioned on a substrate, printed circuit board (PCB), or a motherboard. The substrate or

motherboard can be thermally connected to the coldplate **308** or the bottom plate of the chamber **306** of the thermal shock testing system **300**. Furthermore, the pedestals **350** can thermally connect the plate wall (e.g., top plate **318** or side walls **322**) of the chamber **306** to the surfaces of the “hot” components of the DUT that are positioned on the substrate/motherboard to provide a secondary path of thermal distribution.

(67) Furthermore, the pedestals **350** can be positioned adjacent to “hot” components (e.g., one or more processors) as targeted components as shown in FIG. **6**. The targeted components typically produce a greater thermal output than other components on the motherboard when the components are operating in their normal capacity. By targeting “hot” components on the substrate/motherboard with the pedestals **350**, components having a greater thermal range during operation are subject to a greater thermal range during a thermal shock test. Thus, by targeting “hot” components, the thermal shock testing system **300** can more accurately simulate a thermal stress that the DUT experiences during operation than conventional thermal stress techniques.

(68) In some instances, the liquid-to-liquid thermal shock testing system **300** can be coupled with a liquid cooling system (LCS) **352**, which can be integrated with a unit-under-test (UUT) **354**, as shown in FIG. **3B**. For example, the liquid-to-liquid thermal shock testing system **300** can be configured to couple with the LCS **352**, which can be integrated into an outer casing **356** of the UUT **354**.

(69) The outer casing **356** of the UUT **354** can include channels (similar to the channels **324**) that can be embedded within and traverse throughout the outer casing **356** of the UUT **354**. The channels of the LCS **352** can be fluidly coupled to the channels **324** of the liquid-to-liquid thermal shock testing system **300** such that the temperature regulated fluid from the liquid-to-liquid thermal shock testing system **300** can be utilized by the channels of the LCS **352**. In some instances, the liquid-to-liquid thermal shock testing system **300** can be fluidly coupled to an inlet **310** and an outlet **312** of the LCS **352**. As provided above, the liquid-to-liquid thermal shock testing system **300** can direct temperature regulated fluid into the LCS **352** to conduct a thermal shock test on components adjacent to coldplate(s) **308**.

(70) In other instances, the channels of the LCS **352** further can be proximate (e.g., adjacent) to the coldplate(s) **308** to regulate the coldplate(s) **308**. An interior portion of a wall of the outer casing **356** can include one or more coldplate(s) (e.g., the coldplate **308**). In some cases, the interior region within the outer casing **356** can be or include the chamber **306** of the liquid-to-liquid thermal shock testing system **300**. Furthermore, the coldplate(s) **308** can be proximate (e.g., adjacent) to components of a computer (e.g., one or more processors).

(71) The LCS **352** also can house and thermally regulate electrical components, processors, memory, or any other component suitable for the intended purpose and understood by a person of ordinary skill in the art. The thermal shock testing system **300** of the LCS **352** not only can provide a thermal shock test to components, the LCS **352** can also thermally regulate the UUT **354** by controlling the temperature of the liquid passing through the channels **324** of the thermal testing system **300** and the channels of the LCS **352**, and by utilizing the thermal conductive properties of the pedestals **350**.

(72) In some cases, the LCS **352** can comprise optimized system components, such as pumps **316**, cold plates **308**, pedestals **350**, and heat pipes **324** that may be pre-configured to cool high-power density devices of an autonomous vehicle. For example, the LCS **352** can include cold plates **308** that are proximate to key components within a UUT/DUT as shown in FIG. **6**. By leveraging the LCS **352** to perform the liquid-to-liquid thermal shock test, key components within the UUT/DUT can be more directly targeted than with conventional liquid-to-liquid cooling test techniques.

(73) In some instances, the LCS **352** can be utilized to cool a compute during normal operation (i.e., when the computer is running during AV operation). The LCS **352** can include piping/channels that are integrated in the casing/walls **318**, **320**, **322** of the compute. The casing of the compute can include conductive layers (e.g., pedestals **350** as shown in FIG. **6**) that can be

positioned proximate to components (e.g., “hot” processors) on one side and in contact with the casing having piping/channels on the other side. Thus, during normal operation, the LCS 352 can maintain the components at an optimal or selected temperature range.

(74) Thermal interface material or soldering can be utilized to facilitate the thermal connection between the pedestals 350 and the DUT to improve a temperature transition of the DUT that is positioned within the interior portion of the coldplate 308/chamber 306 of the thermal shock testing system 300. Examples of the thermal interface material can include a thermal grease, a thermal adhesive, a thermal gap filler, a thermally conductive pad, thermal tape, phase-change materials, or any other thermal interface material suitable for the intended purpose and understood by a person of ordinary skill in the art.

(75) FIG. 7 illustrates an example schematic diagram of a thermal shock testing system, according to some aspects of the disclosed technology.

(76) In some instances, similar to the thermal shock testing system 300 of FIG. 4, a thermal shock testing system 700 can include a chiller 402, a feed pump 404, a heater 406, temperature 408 and pressure 410 implementation (e.g., transducers), a 2-way motor controlled valve 412, a 3-way motor controlled valve 414, a centrifugal circulation pump 416, a 3-way bypass valve 418, a bypass/relief service valve 420, and a pressure relief valve 422.

(77) In some instances, the chiller 402, the temperature 408 and pressure 410 instrumentation, and the centrifugal pump 416 can be combined with a cold water tank 424 to form a cooling system 430. In other instances, the heater 406, the temperature 408 and pressure 410 instrumentation, and the centrifugal pump 416 can be combined with a hot water tank 426 to form a heating system 432.

(78) The fluid from the chiller 402 and the heater 406 can flow through the 3-way motor controlled valve 414 into the feed pump 404. The fluid can then flow through the bypass/relief service valve 420 or the pressure relief valve 422 and through the 3-way bypass valve 418. The fluid can then flow through another temperature 408 and pressure 410 instrumentation and into an input of a plate 428. From the output of the plate 428, the fluid can flow through a different temperature 408 and pressure 410 instrumentation, through the 2-way motor controlled valves 412, and into the cooling system 430/heating system 432.

(79) FIG. 8 illustrates an example table of components of a thermal shock testing system 300, 400, according to some aspects of the disclosed technology. In some instances, a power on/off temperature difference can be a factor that drives a temperature change impact on the components on the compute board (e.g., UUT). Some of the equipment parts/components of the LCS liquid-to-liquid thermal shock testing system 300, 400 are listed in the table of FIG. 8. The chiller (cold) 302 can provide a temperature range approximately between -25 degrees Celsius and 15 degrees Celsius. The chiller (hot) 304 can provide a temperature range approximately between 25 degrees Celsius and 90 degrees Celsius. The valves 314 can provide/tolerate a temperature range approximately between -25 degrees Celsius and 95 degrees Celsius. The chamber 306 (e.g., an environmental chamber) can tolerate a temperature range approximately between -25 degrees Celsius and 125 degrees Celsius. The chamber 306 also can include dry nitrogen purging gas capabilities to minimize surface condensation. The thermal shock testing system 300, 400 also can include a pressure transducer 332 (e.g., 0-1 MPa). The thermal shock testing system 300, 400 can further include a temperature transducer 330 (e.g., -50 degrees Celsius to 120 degrees Celsius).

(80) FIG. 9 illustrates an example table of parameters of a thermal shock testing system 300, 400, according to some aspects of the disclosed technology. An example of thermal shock testing parameters is shown in FIG. 9, which include a temperature range between -20 degrees Celsius and 85 degrees Celsius. The temperature range can be modified to be suitable for the intended purpose and understood by a person of ordinary skill in the art.

(81) In some embodiments, the thermal shock testing system parameters can include 50 cycles, a maximum temperature of 85 degrees Celsius, a minimum temperature of -25 degrees Celsius, a ramp rate of less than 10 seconds, a dwell time of 30 minutes at the maximum temperature and the

minimum temperature, a UUT ambient temperature between -20 degrees Celsius and 50 degrees Celsius, and a UUT power on/off option.

(82) In some instances, the chamber **306** of the thermal shock testing system **300** can include a dry nitrogen purging gas to provide a non-condensing transition from one test level (e.g., temperature) to another. The purging gas also can be carbon dioxide or any other purging gas suitable for the intended purpose and understood by a person of ordinary skill in the art to sustain a non-condensing environment during the thermal shock test for a non-frost thermal shock. If a frost condition is needed as an additional condensation test parameter (in parallel with the thermal shock), the dry nitrogen purging gas may not be used. As such, in some instances, the thermal shock testing system **300**, **400** can include two liquid-to-liquid thermal shock tests, one without surface condensation and one with surface condensation.

(83) FIG. **10** illustrates an example thermal shock temperature profile of a thermal shock testing system **300**, **400**, according to some aspects of the disclosed technology. An example test procedure is provided below:

(84) Liquid-to-liquid non-operational or operational thermal shock without UUT surface condensation: 1) Perform a functional, cosmetic, and dimensional inspection of the UUT. 2) Place the UUT in the chamber **306** of the thermal shock testing system **300**, **400**, set the chamber temperature to 25 degrees Celsius with uncontrolled humidity, and start nitrogen gas (N₂) purging. 3) Set the chiller **302**, **402** to the desired temperature (T_{min}) and the boiler **304**, **406** to the desired temperature (T_{max}). 4) Begin cycling at room temperature. Turn on the hot coolant valve **314**, **414**. 5) Allow the UUT to dwell at the high temperature (85 degrees Celsius) for the set dwell time (30 minutes). 6) Turn off the hot coolant valve **314**, **414** and turn on the cold coolant valve **314**, **414** (ramp rate of less than 11 degrees Celsius/second). 7) Allow the UUT to dwell at the low temperature (-25 degrees Celsius) for the set dwell time (30 minutes). 8) Repeat steps 4 through 7 for the set number of cycles. 9) Perform a baseline functional, cosmetic, and dimensional inspection to determine whether any changes or abnormalities occurred during the thermal shock test.

(85) Liquid-to-liquid operational thermal shock without UUT surface condensation: 1) Perform a baseline functional, cosmetic, and dimensional inspection of the UUT. 2) Install a thermocouple at the specific component location, if required. 3) Place the UUT in the chamber **306** of the thermal shock testing system **300**, **400**, set the chamber temperature to 25 degrees Celsius with uncontrolled humidity, and start nitrogen gas (N₂) purging. 4) Boot the UUT and start diagnostic software. Allow the UUT to successfully pass 2 complete cycles of the diagnostics before continuing. Continue running the diagnostic software during the entire thermal shock cycle. 5) Set the chiller **302**, **402** to the desired temperature (T_{min}) and the boiler **304**, **406** to the desired temperature (T_{max}). 6) Begin cycling at room temperature. Turn on the hot coolant valve **314**, **414**. 7) Allow the UUT to dwell at the high temperature (85 degrees Celsius) for the set dwell time (30 minutes). 8) Turn off the hot coolant valve **314**, **414** and turn on the cold coolant valve **314**, **414** (ramp rate of less than 11 degrees Celsius/second). 9) Allow the UUT to dwell at the low temperature (-25 degrees Celsius) for the set dwell time (30 minutes). 10) Repeat steps 5 through 9 for the number of cycles. Monitor the UUT to determine if the diagnostic software reports any failures. 11) Perform a baseline functional, cosmetic, and dimensional inspection to determine whether any changes or abnormalities occurred during the thermal shock test.

(86) Having disclosed some example system components and concepts, the disclosure now turns to FIG. **11**, which illustrate example method **1100** for providing a thermal shock to a unit-under-test. The steps outlined herein are exemplary and can be implemented in any combination thereof, including combinations that exclude, add, or modify certain steps.

(87) The thermal shock testing system can include a computer-implemented control algorithm for directing the coolant hot and cold thermal shock. The computer-implemented control algorithm can include switching to a hot loop, turning on a pump, turning the pump off when a target time has

been reached, switching to a cold loop, turning on the pump, turning the pump off when a target time has been reached, and repeating the above steps until a specified target number of cycles has been reached.

(88) At step **1102**, the method **1100** can include providing a thermal testing system to test a unit-under-test (UUT) with a thermal shock. For example, providing a thermal testing system comprising: a chamber having an inlet and an outlet, the chamber being configured to provide a thermal shock to a unit-under-test (UUT), a pump configured to fluidly connect to the inlet of the chamber and direct a temperature controlled liquid through a channel embedded in the chamber, and a boiler and a chiller fluidly connected to the pump, the temperature of the liquid being controlled by at least one valve configured to alternatively direct hot or cold fluid to the inlet of the chamber.

(89) At step **1104**, the method **1100** can include positioning the UUT into an interior portion of the chamber.

(90) At step **1106**, the method **1100** can include setting the boiler to a high temperature and the chiller to a low temperature.

(91) At step **1108**, the method **1100** can include opening the at least one valve to heat the UUT with the hot fluid.

(92) At step **1110**, the method **1100** can include dwelling the UUT at the high temperature for a first dwell time.

(93) At step **1112**, the method **1100** can include closing the at least one valve to chill the UUT with the cold fluid within a ramp rate.

(94) At step **1114**, the method **1100** can include dwelling the UUT at the low temperature for a second dwell time.

(95) The method **1100** also can include booting the UUT and starting a diagnostic test to monitor the UUT during the thermal shock test. The method **1100** further can include the ramp rate being approximately 11 degrees Celsius per second. The method **1100** additionally can include the first dwell time and the second dwell time being approximately 30 minutes.

(96) In some instances, the method **1100** can further include the chamber being configured to receive the UUT. The channel can be embedded within an outer casing surrounding the chamber. The chamber can be within an outer casing of a liquid cooling system of an autonomous vehicle. The UUT can be a compute of an autonomous vehicle. The thermal testing system can further comprise: a first temperature transducer and a first pressure transducer that are connected to the inlet of the chamber, and a second temperature transducer and a second pressure transducer that are connected to the outlet of the chamber. The thermal testing system can further comprise a bypass valve between the inlet and the outlet of the chamber to maintain the temperature in the channel when the UUT is not connected to the chamber. The hot fluid can be approximately 85 degrees Celsius and the cold fluid is approximately -25 degrees Celsius. The thermal testing system can further comprises a plurality of channels, a first channel of the plurality of channels including a first coil configured to adjust a temperature of a first portion of the chamber, and a second channel of the plurality of channels including a second coil configured to adjust a temperature of a second portion of the chamber. The first coil of the first channel can provide a different temperature than the second coil of the second channel.

(97) FIG. **12** illustrates an example computing system **1200** which can be, for example, any computing device making up internal computing system **110**, remote computing system **150**, a passenger device executing rideshare application **170**, or any other computing device. In FIG. **12**, the components of the computing system **1200** are in communication with each other using connection **1205**. Connection **1205** can be a physical connection via a bus, or a direct connection into processor **1210**, such as in a chipset architecture. Connection **1205** can also be a virtual connection, networked connection, or logical connection.

(98) In some embodiments, computing system **1200** is a distributed system in which the functions

described in this disclosure can be distributed within a datacenter, multiple data centers, a peer network, etc. In some embodiments, one or more of the described system components represents many such components each performing some or all of the function for which the component is described. In some embodiments, the components can be physical or virtual devices.

(99) Example system **1200** includes at least one processing unit (CPU or processor) **1210** and connection **1205** that couples various system components including system memory **1215**, such as read-only memory (ROM) **1220** and random access memory (RAM) **1225** to processor **1210**. Computing system **1200** can include a cache of high-speed memory **1212** connected directly with, in close proximity to, or integrated as part of processor **1210**.

(100) Processor **1210** can include any general purpose processor and a hardware service or software service, such as services **1232**, **1234**, and **1236** stored in storage device **1230**, configured to control processor **1210** as well as a special-purpose processor where software instructions are incorporated into the actual processor design. Processor **1210** may essentially be a completely self-contained computing system, containing multiple cores or processors, a bus, memory controller, cache, etc. A multi-core processor may be symmetric or asymmetric.

(101) To enable user interaction, computing system **1200** includes an input device **1245**, which can represent any number of input mechanisms, such as a microphone for speech, a touch-sensitive screen for gesture or graphical input, keyboard, mouse, motion input, speech, etc. Computing system **1200** can also include output device **1235**, which can be one or more of a number of output mechanisms known to those of skill in the art. In some instances, multimodal systems can enable a user to provide multiple types of input/output to communicate with computing system **1200**. Computing system **1200** can include communications interface **1240**, which can generally govern and manage the user input and system output. There is no restriction on operating on any particular hardware arrangement, and therefore the basic features here may easily be substituted for improved hardware or firmware arrangements as they are developed.

(102) Storage device **1230** can be a non-volatile memory device and can be a hard disk or other types of computer readable media which can store data that are accessible by a computer, such as magnetic cassettes, flash memory cards, solid state memory devices, digital versatile disks, cartridges, random access memories (RAMs), read-only memory (ROM), and/or some combination of these devices.

(103) The storage device **1230** can include software services, servers, services, etc., that when the code that defines such software is executed by the processor **1210**, it causes the system to perform a function. In some embodiments, a hardware service that performs a particular function can include the software component stored in a computer-readable medium in connection with the necessary hardware components, such as processor **1210**, connection **1205**, output device **1235**, etc., to carry out the function.

(104) For clarity of explanation, in some instances, the present technology may be presented as including individual functional blocks including functional blocks comprising devices, device components, steps or routines in a method embodied in software, or combinations of hardware and software.

(105) Any of the steps, operations, functions, or processes described herein may be performed or implemented by a combination of hardware and software services or services, alone or in combination with other devices. In some embodiments, a service can be software that resides in memory of a client device and/or one or more servers of a content management system and perform one or more functions when a processor executes the software associated with the service. In some embodiments, a service is a program or a collection of programs that carry out a specific function. In some embodiments, a service can be considered a server. The memory can be a non-transitory computer-readable medium.

(106) In some embodiments, the computer-readable storage devices, mediums, and memories can include a cable or wireless signal containing a bit stream and the like. However, when mentioned,

non-transitory computer-readable storage media expressly exclude media such as energy, carrier signals, electromagnetic waves, and signals per se.

(107) Methods according to the above-described examples can be implemented using computer-executable instructions that are stored or otherwise available from computer-readable media. Such instructions can comprise, for example, instructions and data which cause or otherwise configure a general purpose computer, special purpose computer, or special purpose processing device to perform a certain function or group of functions. Portions of computer resources used can be accessible over a network. The executable computer instructions may be, for example, binaries, intermediate format instructions such as assembly language, firmware, or source code. Examples of computer-readable media that may be used to store instructions, information used, and/or information created during methods according to described examples include magnetic or optical disks, solid-state memory devices, flash memory, USB devices provided with non-volatile memory, networked storage devices, and so on.

(108) Devices implementing methods according to these disclosures can comprise hardware, firmware and/or software, and can take any of a variety of form factors. Typical examples of such form factors include servers, laptops, smartphones, small form factor personal computers, personal digital assistants, and so on. The functionality described herein also can be embodied in peripherals or add-in cards. Such functionality can also be implemented on a circuit board among different chips or different processes executing in a single device, by way of further example.

(109) The instructions, media for conveying such instructions, computing resources for executing them, and other structures for supporting such computing resources are means for providing the functions described in these disclosures.

(110) Although a variety of examples and other information was used to explain aspects within the scope of the appended claims, no limitation of the claims should be implied based on particular features or arrangements in such examples, as one of ordinary skill would be able to use these examples to derive a wide variety of implementations. Further and although some subject matter may have been described in language specific to examples of structural features and/or method steps, it is to be understood that the subject matter defined in the appended claims is not necessarily limited to these described features or acts. For example, such functionality can be distributed differently or performed in components other than those identified herein. Rather, the described features and steps are disclosed as examples of components of systems and methods within the scope of the appended claims.

(111) Claim language reciting “at least one of” a set indicates that one member of the set or multiple members of the set satisfy the claim. For example, claim language reciting “at least one of A and B” means A, B, or A and B.

Claims

1. A thermal testing system, comprising: a chamber configured to receive a unit-under-test (UUT) within the chamber and to thermally shock the UUT while the UUT is within the chamber, wherein the chamber includes one or more channels; a pump fluidly connected to the one or more channels of the chamber and configured to pump fluids through the one or more channels of the chamber; a boiler fluidly connected to the pump and configured to generate a hot fluid; a chiller fluidly connected to the pump and configured to generate a cold fluid; and at least one valve configured to alternately direct the hot fluid and the cold fluid into the one or more channels using the pump to alternately expose the UUT to a hot temperature and a cold temperature to thermally shock the UUT.

2. The thermal testing system of claim 1, further comprising: a thermally regulated coldplate in the chamber.

3. The thermal testing system of claim 1, wherein the pump is fluidly coupled to a liquid cooling

system of the UUT.

4. The thermal testing system of claim 3, wherein the liquid cooling system is configured to thermally shock the UUT.

5. The thermal testing system of claim 3, wherein the liquid cooling system is configured to thermally regulate a coldplate in the chamber.

6. The thermal testing system of claim 3, wherein the liquid cooling system is configured to house and thermally regulate the UUT.

7. The thermal testing system of claim 6, wherein thermally regulating the UUT includes controlling a temperature of a liquid.

8. The thermal testing system of claim 3, wherein the liquid cooling system includes channels integrated into a casing of the UUT.

9. The thermal testing system of claim 3, wherein an outer casing of the UUT includes embedded channels that traverse throughout the outer casing of the UUT, and wherein the channels of the liquid cooling system are fluidly coupled to the channels embedded in the outer casing of the UUT.

10. The thermal testing system of claim 3, wherein the cold fluid is utilized by the liquid cooling system.

11. A method comprising: placing a unit-under-test (UUT) in a chamber, wherein the chamber is configured to thermally shock the UUT, and wherein the chamber comprises one or more channels; fluidly connecting a pump to the one or more channels of the chamber, wherein the pump is configured to pump fluids through the one or more channels of the chamber; fluidly connecting a boiler to the pump, wherein the boiler is configured to generate a hot fluid; fluidly connecting a chiller to the pump, wherein the chiller is configured to generate a cold fluid; and connecting at least one valve to at least one of the boiler or the chiller, wherein the at least one valve is configured to alternately direct the hot fluid or the cold fluid into the one or more channels using the pump to alternately expose the UUT to a hot temperature and a cold temperature to thermally shock the UUT.

12. The method of claim 11, further comprising: fluidly connecting a coldplate between the pump and the at least one of the boiler or the chiller.

13. The method of claim 11, further comprising: fluidly coupling a liquid cooling system of the UUT to the pump.

14. The method of claim 13, further comprising: thermally shocking the UUT with the liquid cooling system.

15. The method of claim 13, further comprising: thermally regulating a coldplate in the chamber with the liquid cooling system.

16. The method of claim 13, wherein the liquid cooling system is configured to house and thermally regulate the UUT.

17. The method of claim 16, further comprising: controlling a temperature of a liquid to thermally regulate the UUT.

18. The method of claim 13, further comprising: integrating channels of the liquid cooling system into a casing of the UUT.

19. The method of claim 13, further comprising: fluidly connecting channels of the liquid cooling system to channels embedded within and traversing throughout an outer casing of the UUT.

20. The method of claim 11, further comprising: cooling the UUT during normal operation.
